

GDP Analysis

One way of measuring human well-being is to measure the wealth of countries - the value of goods or products and services produced (the Gross Domestic Product or GDP). This can be divided by the total population to find the GDP per capita. Take a look at the table...

Just because Qatar is ranked #1, that doesn't mean everyone is rich and just because the Central African Republic is last doesn't mean everyone there is poor. There is inequality of wealth in every country. There is poverty in the USA and people with great wealth in Malawi. Also, money and GDP is only one measure of human well-being. A few weeks before he was shot, while a candidate for President of the USA, Robert Kennedy said this:

TOP 15	SUS	BOTTOM 15	SUS
1 Qatar	143,427	173 The Gambia	1,599
2 Luxembourg	92,049	174 Ethiopia	1,589
3 Singapore	82,762	175 Comoros	1,548
4 Brunei	73,233	176 Togo	1,450
5 Kuwait	71,020	177 Madagascar	1,437
6 Norway	66,937	178 Guinea-Bissau	1,436
7 United Arab Emirates (UAE)	64,479	179 Guinea	1,313
8 San Marino	60,664	180 Eritrea	1,195
9 Switzerland	58,087	181 Mozambique	1,174
10 USA	54,597	182 Niger	1,048
11 Saudi Arabia	52,183	183 Burundi	911
12 Bahrain	51,714	184 Liberia	882
13 Ireland	49,195	185 Malawi	780
14 Netherlands	47,355	186 Democratic Republic Congo (DRC)	704
15 Australia	46,433	187 Central African Republic	607

Source: World Economic Outlook Database, April 2015, International Monetary Fund. Database updated on 14 April 2015. Accessed on 14 April 2015.

“ Our gross domestic product counts air pollution and advertising, and ambulances to clear our highways of carnage. It counts special locks for our doors and the jails for those who break them. It counts napalm, the cost of a nuclear warhead, and armoured cars for police who fight riots in our streets. It counts rifles and knives, and the television programs which glorify violence in order to sell toys to our children.

Yet the gross domestic product does not allow for the health of our children, the quality of their education, or the joy of their play. It does not include the beauty of our poetry or the strength of our marriages; the intelligence of our public debate or the integrity of our public officials.

It measures neither our wit nor our courage; neither our wisdom nor our learning; neither our compassion nor our devotion to our country; it measures everything, in short, except that which makes life worthwhile.

”

Source: Adapted from Robert F. Kennedy, www.jfklibrary.org/Research/Research-Aids/Ready-Reference/RFK-Speeches/Remarks-of-Robert-F-Kennedy-at-the-University-of-Kansas-March-18-1968.aspx

Read the quote from Robert Kennedy and identify the important things he says that GDP **does not** measure. Suggest some ways that these could be measured.

Find the countries listed in the table and color them on this map. Color the top 15 one color and the bottom 15 a different color. Make a key on your map.

Identify which region of the world each country is in.

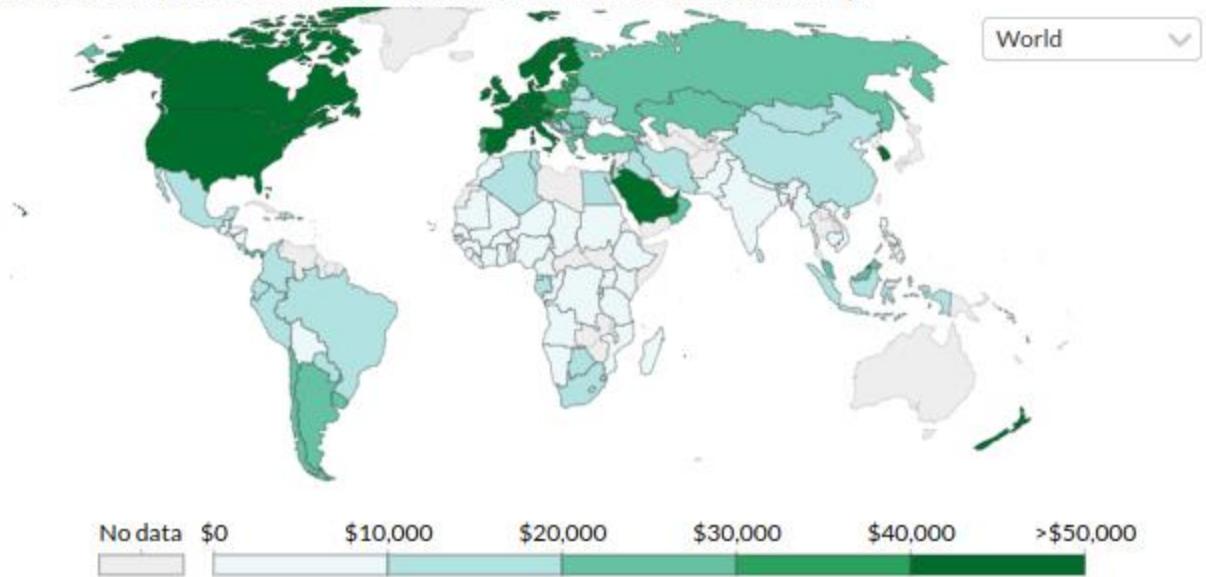
Africa	Asia	Europe	Latin America	Middle East	North America	Oceania

What do you notice about the spatial distribution of GDP per capita in the world?

Gross National Income per capita, 2019

Gross National Income (GNI) per capita is adjusted for price changes over time (inflation) and price differences between countries – it is measured in constant international-\$.

Our World
in Data



Source: Data compiled from multiple sources by World Bank

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What do you notice about the spatial distribution of GNI per capita across the world? Do you see any similarities with the distribution of GDP per capita?

Do you think using economic indicators like GDP and GNI per capita are an effective way to measure a country's development? Why or why not?
